

Cloud Architect

FF09 IT infrastructure, operations and security · ISCO-08 252 · CBS 0812 Systeembeheerders en netwerkspecialisten · seniority senior · Also known as: Cloud Solutions Architect, Cloud Infrastructure Architect

Designs the layout of cloud environments, weighs cost, security and vendor dependency and sets the frameworks that engineers work within.

The cloud architect determines how an organisation structures its landscape with one or more cloud providers, including network separation, identities and failover. Unlike the cloud engineer, this role does not build, and unlike the infrastructure architect it focuses specifically on public cloud and its contractual and financial consequences. Selection tests technical depth, while the role fails on decision making: a design not aligned with security, procurement and the teams who must build on it gets quietly bypassed.

Key figures for this profile

26 skills · 4 competencies to measure · 5 knockout skills · centre of gravity: Digital, data and AI 60%, Cognitive ability and problem solving 14%, Self-management, drive and resilience 8%

1 Competencies to measure

These are the behavioural and ability constructs in this profile. Each one shows which hrmforce questionnaire measures it.

Competencies to measure	Target level	hrmforce instrument	Assessment method	Behavioural anchor at target level
Accuracy and attention to detail Competency (50-framework): Nauwkeurigheid	■■■■■N5	Big Fifty, 360 Feedback	Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst	Sets the standards for completeness and correctness, has samples checked and addresses teams on structural sloppiness.

Competencies to measure	Target level	hrmforce instrument	Assessment method	Behavioural anchor at target level
integrity and dependability Competency (50-framework): Integriteit	 N5	Big Fifty (schaal Integriteit), 360 Feedback, Structureerd interview	Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst	Sets the organisation's integrity standards, enforces them also with influential parties and explains the resulting choices publicly.
Discipline and keeping commitments Competency (50-framework): Discipline	 N5	Big Fifty, 15PF, 360 Feedback	Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst	Anchors the standard for reliable follow through in working agreements and addresses anyone at any level who lets that standard slip.
Stress tolerance Competency (50-framework): Stressbestendigheid	 N5	Big Fifty, 15PF, Mentale Weerbaarheid (4C)	Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst	Keeps the organisation workable in crises, takes decisions under high uncertainty and sets the standard for composed action under pressure.

2 Full skill profile

Every skill in this profile, sorted by weight. The behavioural anchor under each skill belongs to the target level.

T	Skill	Target level	Weight	Knockout	Assessment method	hrmforce instrument
V	Problem analysis Traces persistent organisational problems back to a few root causes and sets the analysis method that other teams will use.	 N5	5	yes	Assessment center	Competency Check, Ability Scan
V	Systems thinking Models the interplay between departments, market and regulation and shifts the intervention to the point with the greatest leverage.	 N5	5	no	Werkproef	Competency Check, Werkproef
V	Software design and architecture Sets the organisation's architecture principles and decides on designs that affect multiple systems.	 N5	5	no	Werkproef	Werkproef, Portfolio
V	Using cloud platforms Determines the organisation's cloud strategy and decides which workloads are placed where.	 N5	5	yes	Kennistoets	Kennistoets (klantspecifiek)

T	Skill	Target level	Weight	Knockout	Assessment method	hrmforce instrument
K	Basic networking knowledge Disseminates networking knowledge in the organisation, sets design principles and reviews network designs from suppliers.	■■■■■N5	5	yes	Kennistoets	Kennistoets (klantspecifiek)
V	Access and identity management Sets the organisation's access policy and accounts for the control of permissions in audits.	■■■■■N5	5	yes	Werkproef	Kennistoets (klantspecifiek), Werkproef
G	Accuracy and attention to detail Sets the standards for completeness and correctness, has samples checked and addresses teams on structural sloppiness.	■■■■■N5	4	no	Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst	Big Fifty, 360 Feedback
V	Stakeholder management Maintains a network reaching governance and political bodies, connects parties with differing interests and safeguards the position of the organisation.	■■■■■N5	4	no	Assessment center	Competency Check, 360 Feedback

T	Skill	Target level	Weight	Knockout	Assessment method	hrmforce instrument
G	integrity and dependability Sets the organisation's integrity standards, enforces them also with influential parties and explains the resulting choices publicly.	■■■■■N5	4	no	Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst	Big Fifty (schaal Integriteit), 360 Feedback, Structureerd interview
G	Discipline and keeping commitments Anchors the standard for reliable follow through in working agreements and addresses anyone at any level who lets that standard slip.	■■■■■N5	4	no	Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst	Big Fifty, 15PF, 360 Feedback
G	Stress tolerance Keeps the organisation workable in crises, takes decisions under high uncertainty and sets the standard for composed action under pressure.	■■■■■N5	4	no	Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst	Big Fifty, 15PF, Mentale Weerbaarheid (4C)

T	Skill	Target level	Weight	Knockout	Assessment method	hrmforce instrument
V	Information security in the work process Sets information security policy and monitors organisation wide that processes meet the requirements set.	■■■■■N5	4	no	Kennistoets	Kennistoets (klantspecifiek)
K	Information security awareness Designs the organisation's awareness programme, measures its effect and adjusts the approach based on measured results.	■■■■■N5	4	no	Kennistoets	Kennistoets (klantspecifiek)
V	Business case and investment analysis Sets the calculation rules and threshold values for investments and weighs the entire investment portfolio of the organisation.	■■■■■N5	4	no	Werkproef	Werkproef, Kennistoets (klantspecifiek)
V	Threat and risk analysis Independently performs a threat analysis on an application, prioritises risks and advises on measures with costs and effect.	■■■■■N4	4	no	Werkproef	Kennistoets (klantspecifiek), Werkproef

T	Skill	Target level	Weight	Knockout	Assessment method	hrmforce instrument
V	Security incident response Independently limits damage during an incident, preserves evidence and delivers a traceable timeline of events.	 N4	4	no	Simulatie	Kennistoets (klantspecifiek), Werkproef
V	IT supplier and contract management Holds supplier meetings on performance and cost, records agreements and intervenes when agreements are not met.	 N4	4	no	Structureerd interview	Structureerd interview, Portfolio
V	Learning from mistakes and incidents Analyses own errors and those of the team, discusses the cause openly in the work meeting and adjusts the agreements.	 N4	3	no	Situational Judgement Test	360 Feedback, Competency Check
V	Professional currency and specialist literature Tracks sources and guidelines structurally, weighs their quality and adapts the own working method to new insights.	 N4	3	no	Portfolio/bewijsstuk	Portfolio, Kennistoets (klantspecifiek)

T	Skill	Target level	Weight	Knockout	Assessment method	hrmforce instrument
V	Writing technical documentation Writes complete documentation for a system or process, tests it with an unfamiliar reader and maintains versions.	 N4	3	no	Werkproef	Werkproef, Portfolio
V	Release management and deployment Draws up a rollout plan with a fallback option, aligns with stakeholders and verifies after rollout that the service works.	 N4	3	no	Werkproef	Kennistoets (klantspecifiek), Werkproef
V	Process automation Describes a process in steps, automates the repeatable steps and builds in checks on errors and exceptions.	 N4	3	no	Werkproef	Werkproef, Portfolio
V	Functional and application management Independently manages an application, prioritises change requests with users and tests new versions before they go live.	 N4	3	no	Werkproef	Kennistoets (klantspecifiek), Werkproef

T	Skill	Target level	Weight	Knockout	Assessment method	hrmforce instrument
V	System administration and monitoring Independently manages a system environment, sets monitoring thresholds and removes recurring causes of disruptions.	 N3	3	yes	Werkproef	Kennistoets (klantspecifiek), Werkproef
V	Data classification and retention Determines classification and retention period for an information flow and checks whether clean up happens as planned.	 N4	2	no	Kennistoets	Kennistoets (klantspecifiek), Werkproef
V	Incident management and troubleshooting Sets an investigation line for an unfamiliar disruption, restores the service and records cause and solution for reuse.	 N3	2	no	Werkproef	Werkproef, Kennistoets (klantspecifiek)

3 Levels per seniority

The same profile with the job family seniority adjustment applied. Target levels are clamped to 1 to 5.

Skill	senior	lead
Problem analysis	N5	N5
Systems thinking	N5	N5
Software design and architecture	N5	N5
Using cloud platforms	N5	N5
Basic networking knowledge	N5	N5
Access and identity management	N5	N5
Accuracy and attention to detail	N5	N5
Stakeholder management	N5	N5
integrity and dependability	N5	N5
Discipline and keeping commitments	N5	N5
Stress tolerance	N5	N5
Information security in the work process	N5	N5
Information security awareness	N5	N5
Business case and investment analysis	N5	N5
Threat and risk analysis	N4	N4
Security incident response	N4	N4
IT supplier and contract management	N4	N4
Learning from mistakes and incidents	N4	N4
Professional currency and specialist literature	N4	N4
Writing technical documentation	N4	N4
Release management and deployment	N4	N4
Process automation	N4	N4
Functional and application management	N4	N4
System administration and monitoring	N3	N3
Data classification and retention	N4	N4

Skill	senior	lead
Incident management and troubleshooting	N3	N3

4 The proficiency scale

Level	Label	Autonomy	Complexity	Scope	Depth of knowledge
N1	Guided	works under supervision and follows instruction	routine, one variable at a time	own task	basic understanding of terminology
N2	Applying	works independently within set frameworks	familiar situations with limited variation	own role	working knowledge, applies standard approach
N3	Proficient	sets own approach and seeks input proactively	several variables, some ambiguity	own team or process	thorough knowledge, weighs alternatives
N4	Advanced	directs others and decides on the approach	complex, with conflicting interests	several teams or a department	in-depth knowledge, advises others
N5	Leading	sets the standard and the policy	strategic, under high uncertainty	organisation, value chain or profession	authority, advances the profession

5 Behavioural anchors per skill

Anchors sit at N1, N3 and N5. N2 and N4 are deliberately not anchored: raters interpolate between them, following the O*NET convention.

Skill	N1	N3	N5
Problem analysis Breaks a problem into parts, separates causes from effects and states which information is needed to move forward.	States precisely what deviates in a malfunction and which data are missing, and puts this to the supervisor.	Splits a recurring complaint into possible causes, tests these with own data and names the most likely cause.	Traces persistent organisational problems back to a few root causes and sets the analysis method that other teams will use.
Systems thinking Describes how parts of a process or organisation influence each other, including feedback, delay and unintended effects.	Names who or what depends on the own task earlier and later in the process.	Maps the chain around a bottleneck, points out the feedback loop and predicts the effect of an intervention.	Models the interplay between departments, market and regulation and shifts the intervention to the point with the greatest leverage.
Software design and architecture Designs the structure of an application or interface, distributes functionality across components and weighs choices on maintainability, performance and security.	Elaborates a supplied design into components and asks questions when the design turns out to be incomplete.	Produces a design for a defined application, records the main choices and alternatives and reviews it with colleagues.	Sets the organisation's architecture principles and decides on designs that affect multiple systems.

Skill	N1	N3	N5
Using cloud platforms Sets up and manages services in a cloud environment, arranges permissions and costs and chooses between available service types based on requirements.	Uses existing cloud services as instructed and reports unusual behaviour or unexpected costs to the administrator.	Independently configures cloud services for an application, arranges permissions and backups and keeps costs and usage in view.	Determines the organisation's cloud strategy and decides which workloads are placed where.
Basic networking knowledge Knows how networks work at a high level such as addressing, routing, ports and name resolution and states where a connection problem may arise.	Explains which parts make up a connection and performs a provided check such as a connectivity test.	Deduces from symptoms in which network layer a problem sits and supports that with own measurements.	Disseminates networking knowledge in the organisation, sets design principles and reviews network designs from suppliers.
Access and identity management Grants permissions based on role and necessity, periodically reviews who can access what and withdraws rights on change or departure.	Processes access requests according to the established role scheme and records every change.	Designs roles and permissions for an application, carries out the periodic review and corrects excessive access.	Sets the organisation's access policy and accounts for the control of permissions in audits.
Accuracy and attention to detail Works carefully, checks own work for errors and keeps to agreements about completeness and correctness of data.	Goes through the own work with a checklist and repairs errors found before the work is passed on.	Builds check moments into the own process, keeps track of errors and prevents repetition by adjusting the method.	Sets the standards for completeness and correctness, has samples checked and addresses teams on structural sloppiness.
Stakeholder management Mapping who has an interest in an initiative and maintaining contact with those parties so that decisions keep their support.	Maintains a list of those involved and informs them about progress according to the agreed rhythm.	Assesses influence and interest per party, chooses a fitting form of contact and discusses conflicting wishes before a decision is taken.	Maintains a network reaching governance and political bodies, connects parties with differing interests and safeguards the position of the organisation.
Integrity and dependability Acting in line with applicable standards and agreements, also without supervision, and being transparent about own interests, mistakes and doubtful cases.	Keeps to agreements and rules of conduct made and reports an own mistake to the manager.	Reports a possible conflict of interest on own initiative and asks for review before a decision is taken.	Sets the organisation's integrity standards, enforces them also with influential parties and explains the resulting choices publicly.

Skill	N1	N3	N5
Discipline and keeping commitments Sticks to agreements, procedures and commitments even without supervision, and reports in good time when a commitment turns out to be unachievable.	Arrives at the agreed time with the agreed work and reports any delay to the supervisor.	Commits only to what is feasible, tracks own commitments and informs those involved as soon as a deadline comes under pressure.	Anchors the standard for reliable follow through in working agreements and addresses anyone at any level who lets that standard slip.
Stress tolerance Keeps delivering work of the same quality under time pressure, opposition or unexpected turns and maintains a businesslike tone with others.	Keeps working on the current task as pressure rises and asks the supervisor which task can wait.	Keeps working in a structured way at peak load, keeps agreements with clients clear and flags early which results are at risk.	Keeps the organisation workable in crises, takes decisions under high uncertainty and sets the standard for composed action under pressure.
Information security in the work process Applies security measures in daily work such as safe sharing, classifying and storing information and flags risky working practices.	Follows the security rules for sharing and storing information and reports a suspected incident immediately.	Weighs security risks when setting new working agreements, adjusts measures and addresses colleagues on unsafe behaviour.	Sets information security policy and monitors organisation wide that processes meet the requirements set.
Information security awareness Knows the most common threats such as phishing, ransomware and deception, recognises their signals and knows which action is then expected.	Recognises an obvious phishing message, does not click and reports the message through the designated channel.	Explains to colleagues how threats work, judges doubtful cases independently and adapts own behaviour to new threats.	Designs the organisation's awareness programme, measures its effect and adjusts the approach based on measured results.
Business case and investment analysis Substantiates a proposal with costs, benefits, assumptions and risks and calculates payback period and return for the decision makers.	Fills a standard business case template with supplied figures and names which data are still missing.	Builds an own business case with scenarios, makes the assumptions explicit and defends the outcome in the meeting.	Sets the calculation rules and threshold values for investments and weighs the entire investment portfolio of the organisation.
Threat and risk analysis Maps threats, weaknesses and consequences for a system or process, weighs likelihood against impact and names appropriate measures.	Completes a risk inventory using a given list of threats and submits the outcome to the specialist.	Independently performs a threat analysis on an application, prioritises risks and advises on measures with costs and effect.	Determines the organisation's risk appetite and analysis method and accounts for the security risk picture to the board.

Skill	N1	N3	N5
Security incident response Acts on a security incident following the runbook by containing it, preserving evidence, recovering and informing the right parties in time.	Reports a suspected incident immediately, touches nothing and follows the coordinator's instructions.	Independently limits damage during an incident, preserves evidence and delivers a traceable timeline of events.	Leads the organisation wide response team, decides on external communication and improves the runbook after every exercise.
IT supplier and contract management Manages agreements with IT suppliers on delivery, performance and cost, monitors compliance and addresses suppliers on deviations.	Checks invoices and delivered services against the contract and reports deviations to the contract manager.	Holds supplier meetings on performance and cost, records agreements and intervenes when agreements are not met.	Sets the organisation's supplier policy, concludes the main contracts and decides on termination or switching.
Learning from mistakes and incidents Investigates after an error or incident what happened, names the cause without shifting blame and changes the working method on that point.	Reports an own error to the supervisor at once and repeats the task following the corrected instruction.	Analyses own errors and those of the team, discusses the cause openly in the work meeting and adjusts the agreements.	Ensures incidents are reported safely across the organisation, has causes analysed structurally and works the lessons into policy and standards.
Professional currency and specialist literature Follows developments in the own profession through literature, guidelines and networks and works relevant new insights into own practice.	Reads the professional information received and names which part matters for the own work.	Tracks sources and guidelines structurally, weighs their quality and adapts the own working method to new insights.	Assesses the state of the field, weighs conflicting research and determines which guidelines the organisation will follow from now on.
Writing technical documentation Writes manuals, support documentation and decision records that a reader without prior knowledge can follow step by step and that stay current.	Completes a documentation template with the steps of a task and has the text checked by a colleague.	Writes complete documentation for a system or process, tests it with an unfamiliar reader and maintains versions.	Sets the organisation's documentation standard and ensures documentation is part of every delivery.

Skill	N1	N3	N5
Release management and deployment Plans and carries out the rollout of new versions, checks operation before and after and ensures a rollback stays possible.	Executes the steps of a rollout plan and reports immediately when a step does not give the expected result.	Draws up a rollout plan with a fallback option, aligns with stakeholders and verifies after rollout that the service works.	Sets the organisation's release policy, decides on rollout windows and structurally improves the lead time of changes.
Process automation Analyses a recurring work process, builds or commissions automation of its steps and checks that the outcome stays reliable.	Runs an existing automation and reports when the outcome differs from what was expected.	Describes a process in steps, automates the repeatable steps and builds in checks on errors and exceptions.	Determines the organisation's automation agenda and decides which processes are and are not automated.
Functional and application management Keeps an application working and fitting for users by collecting needs, managing settings and coordinating changes with the supplier.	Handles user questions about an application as instructed and records requests in the designated register.	Independently manages an application, prioritises change requests with users and tests new versions before they go live.	Determines how functional management is organised and decides on the lifespan of applications.
System administration and monitoring Keeps systems running by managing settings, updates and permissions, sets up monitoring and acts on signals before users are affected.	Performs scheduled maintenance tasks and updates according to the runbook and reports deviations in monitoring signals.	Independently manages a system environment, sets monitoring thresholds and removes recurring causes of disruptions.	Sets the organisation's administration and monitoring standards and decides on the design of the system environment.
Data classification and retention Classifies information by sensitivity and importance, links retention periods to it and ensures deletion and archiving actually happen.	Assigns a classification label according to the scheme and refers unclear cases to the administrator.	Determines classification and retention period for an information flow and checks whether clean up happens as planned.	Designs the organisation's classification and retention policy and accounts for it in audits and supervision.
Incident management and troubleshooting Takes in disruptions, establishes the cause through targeted steps, restores the service and keeps reporters and stakeholders informed.	Logs a disruption completely, works through the standard steps and escalates as soon as own steps do not work.	Sets an investigation line for an unfamiliar disruption, restores the service and records cause and solution for reuse.	Designs the organisation's incident process, leads the response to major disruptions and accounts for it to management and clients.

6 Assessment methods and validity

The validities are the corrected meta-analytic estimates from Sackett, Zhang, Berry and Lievens (2022) in the Journal of Applied Psychology, which replace the older Schmidt and Hunter (1998) figures. The spread matters as much as the mean: with a high SD, validity varies strongly by context.

Assessment method	rho	SD	What it is
Assessment center	0.29	0.09	Multiple exercises, multiple assessors, dimension-wise scoring.
Werkproef	0.33	0.09	The candidate performs a representative work sample under standardised conditions.
Kennistoets	0.40	0.13	Test of declarative job knowledge, usually assembled per client.
Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst	0.40	0.15	Self-report of behavioural preferences. At hrmforce the Big Fifty and the 15PF.
Simulatie	-	-	Simulated work situation, usually digital, with standardised scoring.
Structureerd interview	0.42	0.19	Behaviour-based interview with fixed questions and a rating scale per question.
Situational Judgement Test	0.12	0.11	Scenario with response options, scored on knowledge or behavioural tendency.
Portfolio/bewijsstuk	-	-	A collection of prior work or results, assessed against fixed criteria.

7 Assessment instruments for this job

hrmforce instrument	Skills	What it measures
Kennistoets (klantspecifiek)	14	Toets van vakkennis, per klant samengesteld
Werkproef	13	Representatief werkfragment onder gestandaardiseerde condities
Portfolio	5	Beoordeling van eerder werk tegen vaste criteria
360 Feedback	5	Meervoudige beoordeling op gedragsankers
Competency Check	4	Competentiebeoordeling op gedragsniveau
Big Fifty	3	Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst, 150 items, 25 factoren
Structureerd interview	2	Gedragsgericht interview met vaste opzet
15PF	2	Persoonlijkheidsprofiel, korter alternatief voor de Big Fifty
Ability Scan	1	Capaciteitentest: verbaal, numeriek en abstract redeneervermogen

hrmforce instrument	Skills	What it measures
Big Fifty (schaal Integriteit)	1	
Mentale Weerbaarheid (4C)	1	Mentale weerbaarheid volgens het 4C-model

8 How to use this profile

1. Agree the profile with the hiring manager before the first candidate is measured. Weights shifted afterwards make the outcome indefensible.
2. Choose the assessment method per skill from the Assessment method column. Combine at most three methods per candidate.
3. Calibrate the assessors in a two-hour session using the anchors in chapter 5. Anchors without rater training deliver little.
4. Fill in the match calculator and discuss the gaps in the development conversation. Type A and type G are selection criteria, not one-quarter development goals.

Source: hrmforce Skills Framework 2.0, version 2.0.0, built 2026-09-08. Crosswalks to ESCO v1.2.1, O*NET 31.0, Lightcast Open Skills, SFIA 9, DigComp 3.0, EntreComp, LifeComp, GreenComp, Allit, WEF Future of Jobs 2025, ISCO-08 and the Dutch CBS occupational classification BRC 2014 edition 2025. This profile is a starting point, not a standard: align it with your own organisation before selecting on it.